zack.cx | designer | zckgrt@gmail.com | XP: 2007-2026

{Hand-written by Zachary Ryan Gort}

Lately, I have been thinking about human intent in the era of a.i. and consequently developing my own thesis where I treat "the sentence." as a primary product primitive, from which the user-experience* is built upon.

*I led with technical jargon, but in human-speak, what we say matters. I say that in the face of agentic automation, not in spite of it, but aware, appreciative, albeit apprehensive in informing & influencing human wayfinding.

I stubbornly—and genuinely—believe human intent matters most, ifimaybefrank.com

best,
Zack

Career Experience (XP):
Wolfgang & Co._Founder_Current | Phenom/UX Strategist_02/2025–05/2025 | Publicis Sapient_Senior UX Designer_04/2022–03/2023 | Code & Theory_Senior Interaction Designer_08/2021–04/2022 | Elva Design Group_Senior UX Designer_04/2021–08/2021 | HUGE Inc._Senior UX Designer_03/2021–04/2021 | PFSweb LiveArea_Manager, UX_01/2020–02/2021 | FlightPath_Senior UX Designer_08/2018–01/2020 | Workarea_Senior UX Designer_07/2017–09/2018 | 03 World_UX Designer_07/2016–06/2017 | One Sixty Over Ninety_Interaction Designer_09/2014–07/2016 |

Selected Outcomes // Publicis Sapient / BNY Mellon–Pershing X (Lead Product Designer / de facto Product Owner & team lead): analyzed every legacy application, mapped and socialized the work across the team, shipped a viable modernized financial product ecosystem for one of the largest banking entities in the world — an industry-first platform with component patterns that keep data alive across multi-step flows; product launched live and contract extension secured // GNC (via Elva Design Group): ground-up Shopify Plus build with modular, component-based design system optimized for continued optimization; Lead UX on IA, UI prototypes, and design systems // Code & Theory / TikTok For Business (Lead UX Designer, Acting ACD): competitive audits, market research, feature definition, and client-facing strategy // 160OVER90 / Kent State (and multi-campus university work): proprietary navigation system designed ground-up for institutional complexity; mobile-first system serving eight campuses as one coherent experience // Turn5 / Xoxide e-commerce platforms (AmericanMuscle, AmericanTrucks, CorvetteGuys, et al.): senior web and graphic design supporting platforms that moved millions of dollars of merchandise to a fanatical fanbase; single-product work that became the face of the commerce experience // recurring pattern across engagements: de facto or interim product ownership, design systems and component libraries, headless CMS/content strategy, team lead and mentorship of junior designers, client-facing lead, and high-pressure delivery under tight constraints ($20K / three weeks / two sites / one system)

— zack g., thinker & maker